



Comcast president fail

Comcast's pres of tech loses connection while boasting about how great cable is for connectivity. <http://digit.in/nov20-05>



Gardenscapes ads banned

Homescapes and Gardenscapes ads are getting rightly banned for being misleading. <http://digit.in/nov20-06>

Combating e-waste at a grassroots level

A restructured circular economy is paramount to tackling the e-waste predicament

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s technology gets more and more integrated into a majority of the population's daily lives, there is an

unavoidable surge in e-waste that is an unfortunate and inevitable byproduct. As technology improves, the urge to buy newer, cutting-edge products get stronger, even in some of the most price-conscious societies around the world. The Indian audience is certainly part of this price-wary consumer demographic, however, the introduction of affordable products chock full of features causes even such a demographic to ultimately purchase more electronic products. Due to the rampant increase in purchasing power, purchasing will, and the sheer volume of products, the e-waste predicament is getting out of hand, since people often throw out old gadgets, especially appliances, wires, and the works, when they are replaced with new ones. To add to this, you cannot ignore that several companies intentionally plan the obsolescence of their older models, pretty much forcing new purchases.

Due to all the above reasons and numerous others, the production of e-waste across the globe is ramping up eerily fast. According to the UN's Global E-waste Monitor 2020, India



is ranked the third largest electronic waste generator in the world only trailing behind China and the USA. These three countries conjointly contributed a whopping 38 per cent of the total of 53.6 million metric tonnes of e-waste generated across the globe in 2019. Out of this figure, only a paltry 17.4 per cent (9.3 million tonnes) of e-waste was recycled globally. India alone generated 3.2 million metric tonnes of e-waste in 2019 and our country has a notoriously low recycling capacity. The same study also identified e-waste as the fastest accelerating waste stream in the world.

WASTAGE OF RAW MATERIALS AND ENVIRONMENTAL HAZARD

Electronic waste or e-waste comes from the large volumes of discarded EEE (Electrical and Electronic Equipment) across the globe. As per the Global E-waste Monitor 2020, on average, the total weight of global EEE consumption increases annually by a whopping 2.5 million metric tonnes. This drastic increase, in turn, generates a waste stream (e-waste) that contains valuable as well as hazardous materials. E-waste

is also known as WEEE (Waste Electrical and Electronic Equipment) primarily in Europe. This generally consists of electronic items such as discarded monitors, motherboards, earphones, TV sets, ACs, refrigerators, mobile phones, and cables.

These electronic devices consist of a complex mix of materials including gold, silver, copper, platinum, palladium, lithium, cobalt, and other such valuable elements. According to a blog by Columbia University, the US EPA (Environmental Protection Agency) stated that one metric tonne of circuit boards can contain anywhere between 40 to 800 times the amount of gold and 30 to 40 times the amount of copper mined from one metric tonne of ore in the US. Additionally, electronic devices also house toxic heavy metals such as lead, mercury, cadmium, beryllium, PVC plastic, and other hazardous chemicals, which take a toll on human health as well as on the environment. Therefore, by failing to recycle a majority of e-waste generated, there's a release of toxic chemicals in the environment as well as a loss of valuable resources that could